

F R E E S A M P L E

Practice Test 1

*5-question sample pack — original advanced practice
for students targeting 1500+ on the Digital SAT*

What's inside:

- 3 Reading and Writing questions (1 Band 6, 2 Band 7)
- 2 Math questions (1 Module 1 hard, 1 Module 2 hard)
- Full answer key with detailed distractor analysis, labeled by trap type

How to use this sample:

Attempt all 5 questions under timed conditions before reading the answer key.
Recommended time: 10–12 minutes total.

Before you begin

This sample contains 5 questions selected from **1600 SAT Lab Practice Test 1**. They are not the easiest items in the test, and they are not the hardest. They are five questions chosen to demonstrate the kind of distractor design and analytical depth that the full test consistently delivers.

Try each question under timed conditions. The full test runs 2 hours 14 minutes for 98 questions, which works out to about 80 seconds per question on average — though strong items in the Reading and Writing section often warrant more time, while early Math items take less.

After attempting all 5, read the answer key. Pay particular attention to the **"Why a real student might pick each wrong answer"** sections. That's where the test's value concentrates: not in marking what's right, but in explaining why the wrong answers were designed to look right.

What to expect from your performance

If you get **4 or 5 correct**, you are already operating in 1500+ territory. The full test will calibrate where in that band you sit and reveal the specific item types that still trip you up under time pressure.

If you get **2 or 3 correct**, you are at the modal level for strong 1400-range students. The full test concentrates on exactly the kinds of distractor traps you are currently falling for.

If you get **0 or 1 correct**, this test is harder than your current level. The honest recommendation: complete the official Bluebook practice tests first. Return to this material when you are consistently scoring 1400+ on those.

Reading and Writing — Sample

3 questions · approximately 6 minutes recommended · no calculator

Question 1

Researchers studying the effects of remote work on professional development have noted that workers in fully remote positions often report receiving less mentoring than those in hybrid arrangements. Some have argued that this finding shows fully remote work is incompatible with effective career growth. However, the data primarily reflect the experiences of workers in fields where mentoring traditionally occurs through informal in-person contact; in fields where mentoring takes place primarily through structured remote-friendly programs, the difference between fully remote and hybrid workers' mentoring access tends to be much smaller. This suggests that _____

Which choice most logically completes the text?

- A) workers who want stronger mentoring should choose hybrid arrangements over fully remote ones.
- B) structured remote-friendly mentoring programs can eliminate the mentoring disadvantage of fully remote work.
- C) the impact of remote work on mentoring depends on how mentoring is normally delivered in a field.
- D) fields that rely on informal in-person mentoring are likely to adopt structured remote-friendly programs over time.

Question 2

Many ecologists have argued that the introduction of non-native species inevitably reduces biodiversity in local ecosystems. Recent long-term studies in temperate forests, however, have shown that certain non-native species can coexist with native ones for extended periods without measurable losses in species count. Although these findings apply to specific non-native species, they do not undermine the broader concern about invasive species that have caused well-documented ecological harm in other contexts. Rather, they suggest that the relationship between non-native species and biodiversity may depend on factors that the traditional view does not adequately address.

Which choice best describes the function of the underlined sentence in the text as a whole?

- A) It accepts the temperate-forest findings while limiting their wider implications.
- B) It defends the opening argument against the temperate-forest evidence.
- C) It contradicts the findings about non-native species in temperate forests.
- D) It asserts that the traditional view overlooks factors shaping the relationship between non-native species and biodiversity.

Question 3

Text 1

For more than a century, observers have noted that immigrant communities, on average, exhibit higher rates of entrepreneurship than native-born populations in the countries to which they immigrate. The pattern appears across many destination countries and many different source populations.

Text 2

Several factors may account for the persistent association between immigration and entrepreneurship. Immigrants frequently face labor-market discrimination that limits their access to traditional employment, leading some to start their own businesses as an alternative. They may also bring networks of capital and trust from their countries of origin that facilitate small-business formation. And the selection of migration itself tends to favor individuals with high tolerance for risk — precisely the disposition entrepreneurship requires.

How does Text 2 relate to Text 1?

- A) It refines the pattern in Text 1 by identifying which immigrant subgroups account for the entrepreneurship rates.
- B) It strengthens the pattern in Text 1 by adding new evidence from additional destination countries.
- C) It implies that the pattern in Text 1 is primarily attributable to immigrants' tolerance for risk.
- D) It offers possible explanations for the trend documented in Text 1.

Math — Sample

2 questions · approximately 4 minutes recommended · Desmos or equivalent calculator permitted

Question 4

A clothing store marks up wholesale prices by 60% to set the retail price. During a sale, the retail price is reduced by 25%. The sale price is what percent of the wholesale price?

- A) 35%
- B) 120%
- C) 135%
- D) 145%

Question 5

Researchers examined the 300 students enrolled in an introductory chemistry course at a university. Students chose whether to attend optional weekly review sessions offered throughout the term. The mean final exam score of students who attended the sessions was 9 points higher than the mean score of students who did not attend.

Which of the following is the most appropriate conclusion based on the design of this study?

- A) Attending the review sessions caused higher final exam scores for the students in this course.
- B) Attending review sessions causes higher final exam scores for college students in general.
- C) For the students in this course, attending the review sessions is associated with higher final exam scores, but causation cannot be established.
- D) For college students in general, attending review sessions is associated with higher final exam scores.

Answer Key & Distractor Analysis

Read this section *after* attempting all 5 questions. Each entry contains the correct answer, full explanation, distractor reasoning labeled by trap type, and — most importantly — an analysis of why a real student might select each wrong answer. That last part is where the test's analytical value concentrates.

#	Section	Skill	Band	Correct
1	R&W	Inferences	B7	C
2	R&W	Text Structure and Purpose	B7	A
3	R&W	Cross-Text Connections	B6	D
4	Math M1	Percentages (markup & discount)	Hard	B
5	Math M2	Evaluating statistical claims	Hard	C

Question 1 — Inferences (Band 7)

Correct answer: C

The passage establishes a contrast: the mentoring gap is large in fields where mentoring is informal and in-person, but much smaller in fields with structured remote-friendly programs. The supported inference is conditional — the effect of remote work on mentoring varies with how a field normally delivers mentoring. Option C captures this conditional structure without adding advice, causation, or prediction, none of which the passage supplies.

DISTRACTOR LOGIC

- A: [Recommendation]** Converts a descriptive pattern into advice. The passage reports how mentoring access varies; it never evaluates what any worker should do.
- B: [Degree overreach]** The passage's qualifier is "much smaller," not zero — a smaller gap is not an eliminated one. B also smuggles in causation: the passage correlates field type with gap size but never shows that the programs themselves close the gap.
- C:** Correct.
- D: [Unsupported prediction]** The passage contains no forecast. Whether fields will change their mentoring practices is a claim about the future that no sentence supports.

WHY AREALSTUDENTMIGHTPICK EACHWRONGANSWER

- A:** Students translate findings into advice, especially when the passage frames the stakes as "career growth." The move from "the gap is smaller in some fields" to "workers should pick hybrid" feels natural but is categorically outside what "this suggests that" can carry.
- B:** This is the trap for students reading fast with good comprehension. B tracks the passage's mechanism and direction correctly; only the degree is wrong. Students round "much smaller" up to "gone." The deeper flaw — that the passage never establishes the programs as the cause of the smaller gap — catches even students who notice the degree problem and talk themselves back into B because "the programs are clearly what's doing the work."
- D:** D survives on outside plausibility: if structured programs shrink the gap, fields would rationally adopt them. That reasoning happens in the student's head, not in the passage. Answers that "make sense" without textual support are precisely the ones designed to punish inference-by-worldview.

Question 2 — Text Structure and Purpose (Band 7)

Correct answer: A

The underlined sentence explicitly concedes the temperate-forest findings ("Although these findings apply to specific non-native species") and then limits their scope ("they do not undermine the broader concern..."). The function is qualification: accept the finding, bound its implications. It does not pit the opening argument against the temperate-forest study — it affirms both.

DISTRACTOR LOGIC

A: Correct.

B: **[Half-right]** The supported half: the sentence does reaffirm the broader concern, which echoes the opening argument. The unsupported half: "against the temperate-forest evidence" casts the sentence as opposition, when it explicitly accepts those findings.

C: **[Concession misread]** The sentence opens with concessive language ("Although these findings apply..."). Its negation ("do not undermine") bounds the findings' implications; it does not dispute the findings themselves.

D: **[Wrong-sentence function]** D accurately describes the function of the passage's final sentence ("Rather, they suggest that the relationship... may depend on factors that the traditional view does not adequately address") — not the underlined one. True of the passage, wrong about the assigned sentence.

WHY AREALSTUDENTMIGHTPICEACHWRONGANSWER

B: Students anchor on the echo — "the broader concern about invasive species" repeats the opening argument's substance — and register the sentence as taking that argument's side. What they miss is that the sentence simultaneously accepts the new findings, so "defends X against Y" mischaracterizes a sentence that endorses both X and Y.

C: Students scan "do not undermine" as negation and read negation as contradiction, without parsing what is being not-undermined. The concessive opener is the signal they skip under time pressure.

D: This is the trap built for strong readers. D is a correct paraphrase of the passage's concluding takeaway — its main point. Students who processed the passage globally, and answer from overall meaning rather than the assigned sentence, select it. Time pressure converts "the function of this sentence" into "the point of this passage."

Question 3 — Cross-Text Connections (Band 6)

Correct answer: D

Text 1 establishes a trend (immigrants entrepreneurial at higher rates across countries and populations). Text 2 takes that trend as given ("the persistent association between immigration and entrepreneurship") and proposes three factors — labor-market discrimination, capital and trust networks, and self-selection of risk-tolerant migrants — that could explain why the trend exists. The relationship is explanatory: Text 2 offers mechanisms, not data, refinements, or reattributions.

DISTRACTOR LOGIC

- A: [Unsupported specificity]** Text 2 performs no subgroup analysis. Its factors apply broadly across immigrant populations rather than differentiating which subgroups account for which share of the rates.
- B: [Mechanisms mistaken for evidence]** Text 2 introduces no new empirical cases. It accepts Text 1's empirical claim and proposes factors that might explain it.
- C: [Part of a claim]** Risk tolerance is one of three coordinate factors, alongside labor-market discrimination and capital networks. Text 2 never singles it out as primary.
- D:** Correct.

WHY AREALSTUDENTMIGHTPICK EACHWRONGANSWER

- A:** "Refines" sounds analytical, and enumerating three factors can feel like refinement. But refinement implies subgroup or scope distinctions, and Text 2 draws none — every factor is offered for immigrant populations generally.
- B:** Hedge-blindness. Text 2's markers — "may account," "frequently," "tends to" — flag its factors as proposed mechanisms, not reported findings. Under time pressure, "labor-market discrimination" and "networks of capital" read like data, and the echo of "destination countries" from Text 1 reinforces the impression that new evidence has been added.
- C:** Vividness and position. The risk-tolerance factor is the most memorable of the three ("precisely the disposition entrepreneurship requires") and arrives last, so students elevate it to the main claim; "primarily" then formalizes the overreach. The parallel structure ("frequently... also... And...") marks the three factors as coordinate, which is exactly what C denies.

Question 4 — Percentages, markup and discount (Math M1, Hard)

Correct answer: B (120%)

Estimate before computing. The discount applies to the marked-up price: $0.75 \times 1.60 = 1.20 > 1$, so the sale price must exceed 100% of wholesale. That single check eliminates A in seconds. The remaining three choices all survive it — by design — so the estimate narrows the field but does not finish the question.

To finish, plug in a wholesale price of \$100. Markup: $\$100 \times 1.60 = \160 retail.

Discount: $\$160 \times 0.75 = \120 sale price. \$120 is 120% of the \$100 wholesale price.

Percentage changes compound multiplicatively: $\text{wholesale} \times 1.60 \times 0.75 = \text{wholesale} \times 1.20$.

DISTRACTOR LOGIC

- A:** **[Additive percentages]** $60 - 25 = 35$. Treats the two percent changes as points on the same base. Also the only choice below 100%, so the estimation check alone removes it.
- B:** Correct.
- C:** **[Additive on the base]** $100 + 60 - 25 = 135$. Adds the markup as 60 points, then subtracts the discount as 25 points, never compounding either.
- D:** **[Discount misreferenced]** Applies the 25% reduction to the 60-point markup instead of to the retail price: 25% of 60 is 15, and $100 + 60 - 15 = 145$.

WHY AREALSTUDENTMIGHTPICKEACHWRONGANSWER

- A:** The classic linear-arithmetic error under time pressure. A student who picks 35% skipped both the estimate and the compounding structure — which is why the item keeps it: it cleanly separates students who sanity-check from students who subtract.
- C:** The student passed the ballpark — the answer is correctly above 100% — but still works in points, offsetting 100 by +60 and -25 without ever multiplying.
- D:** The trap for students who avoided A and C. Hunting for the compound structure, they apply the discount to the wrong base — the increment rather than the whole retail price. "The retail price is reduced by 25%" becomes, in their working, "the markup is reduced by 25%." D survives the estimation check, so nothing but a correct setup removes it.

Question 5 — Evaluating statistical claims (Math M2, Hard)

Correct answer: C

Two independent design checks decide this question: assignment and selection.

Assignment: students chose whether to attend — there was no random assignment to sessions. Without it, pre-existing differences between attendees and non-attendees (prior achievement, motivation, study habits) could produce the 9-point gap on their own, so the sessions cannot be concluded to have caused the higher scores. For example, if attendees already had higher grades on work completed before the sessions began, prior ability alone would explain the result.

Selection: the 300 students are one chemistry course, not a random sample of any wider population, so nothing supports extending even the association beyond this course.

The only claim the design supports is C: an association, within this group, with causation left open.

DISTRACTOR LOGIC

- A: [Causal overreach]** Correct scope, wrong claim. Self-selected groups cannot support a causal conclusion, because attendance may be confounded with pre-existing differences.
- B: [Causal and scope overreach]** Compounds A's error with generalization to students never sampled. Least attractive, but it completes the logical space: these items are built on the two axes of causal-versus-associational and this-group-versus-general-population.
- C:** Correct.
- D: [Scope overreach]** Correct on the causation axis, wrong on the population axis. Without random selection from a broader population, the association cannot be extended to college students in general.

WHY AREALSTUDENTMIGHTPICKEACHWRONGANSWER

- A:** The comparison reads like an experiment — two groups, one outcome measure — and students mentally supply the missing randomization. The tell is a single phrase: "students chose whether to attend." Miss it, and A looks like the straightforward reading of the result.
- B:** Students who both accept the causal reading and treat one course as representative. Rare among strong test-takers, but its presence forces every student to evaluate the two axes separately rather than pattern-matching to "the cautious-sounding option."
- D:** The trap built for high scorers. Students who have internalized "correlation is not causation" reject A and B, feel the safety of the word "associated," and stop checking the second axis. Getting the causation axis right buys nothing on the scope axis — and the design fails both randomization requirements, not just one.

That's the sample.

If this kind of distractor analysis is useful for your prep, the full **1600 SAT Lab Practice Test 1** contains 98 questions across four modules, with the same depth of explanation for every item.

FULL TEST — 98 QUESTIONS — \$19

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